

04tris. Storyboards

Interazione Uomo Macchina
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Human Computer Interaction
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Storyboard

- “A graphical depiction of the outward appearance of the intended system, without any accompanying system functionality”
- A hand-drawn comic that features the execution of a task (like a concrete scenario)
- With a few panels (sequence of sketches) it conveys what a person may accomplish
 - Always include people
- They communicate **flow**, showing what happens **at key points** in time
- No artistic skills are required
 - Not about “nice pictures”
 - About communicating ideas



What To Find In a Storyboard

- Illustrate a goal (for the task)
- How a task unfolds (people interacting among themselves and with devices)
 - Repeated for all significant steps
- At the end, how they accomplish their goals (satisfactory outcome)
- Storyboards are **all about tasks**

Example

This storyboard illustrates how the app had already downloaded the daily recipe to the user's smartphone, so he could look it up and check the shopping list while on the underground, before shopping for ingredients and making a healthy meal.



Example

This storyboard illustrates how the app can show the user that a home cooked meal can be quicker than ordering food delivery, using left over ingredients in the fridge.



Example



Storyboards Should Convey...

- Setting

- People involved
- Environment
- Task being accomplished

- Sequence

- What steps are involved?
 - Not the detailed UI
 - What role the UI plays in helping users achieve their goal?
- What leads someone to use the system?
 - The “trigger” for the task
- What task is being illustrated?

- Satisfaction

- What’s the motivation for the user?
 - The end point to reach after all the steps
- What’s the end result?
- What need are you “satisfying”?

Handling Dynamicity In Storyboards

- Traditional storyboarding
 - “Comic book” conventions: actors, speech bubbles, background
 - Notes attached to each scene explaining what is happening
- Scored storyboards
 - When the user interface is highly dynamic, or contains specific media elements
 - Add specific annotations focusing on movement, colors, sounds, ...
- Text-only storyboards
 - When the interaction behavior is too complex to compact into an illustration, use a longer text description

Why Hand-drawn?

- Quick
 - No need to spend time in graphics tools (they would “push” you to focus on details, too)
 - Able to experiment different scenarios
- Imprecise
 - Users feel free to express more comments and suggestions w.r.t. a more “polished” version
 - Focus on the content (the graphics is obviously ignored)
 - No distraction by fonts, colors, icons, ...

~~Drawing~~ Sketching People



Stick People



Block People



Blob People



Star People



Triangle People



Use Your
Imagination

Star man versatility



neutral



pointing



ballet

Benefits of Storyboards

- Emphasize how an interface accomplishes a task
- Focus the conversation and feedback on user tasks
- Get everyone on same page about the app's goals
- Avoid nitpicking about user interface details (buttons, etc.)

References

- Alan Dix, Janet Finlay, Gregory Abowd, Russell Beale: Human Computer Interaction, 3rd Edition, Chapter 15 “Task Analysis”
- David Benyon: Designing Interactive Systems, Chapter 11 “Task Analysis”
- <http://www.usabilitybok.org/task-analysis>
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- changes were made by Professor Maurizio Mancini

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 - <http://www.inf.ed.ac.uk/teaching/courses/hci/0708/lects/tasks.pdf>
 - https://www.tutorialspoint.com/human_computer_interface/design_process_and_task_analysis.htm
 - <https://www.slideshare.net/alanjohndix/hci-3e-ch-15-task-analysis>
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